

Getting 6S Success ready for traffic

What must be true before visitors arrive, where \$250 should go, and what the media pipeline can produce. Every figure here was measured when this document was built. Nothing is forecast.

The site cannot take money right now. All 6 of 6 payment links on the live site are deactivated in Stripe. Anyone who clicks buy reaches a dead link, and has for days. The repository's links are active, so one deploy fixes it. Nothing else in this plan matters until that happens.

Why nothing caught this

Every check that existed was true. The pages return 200. The payment links return 200 as well: a deactivated Stripe link serves the same 550 KB JavaScript shell as a working one and only says 'no longer active' once the browser runs it, so no status check can tell them apart. The repository's links are correct, which is exactly what made it invisible. There is now a check that asks Stripe's API whether the links the live site serves are active, and it runs in preflight.

Where things actually stand

	Measured	Reads as
Production build	4 of 4 assets differ from the repository	Serving a build from before this month's work
Payment links, live	6 of 6 deactivated in Stripe	Revenue outage
Zone pages with a picture	102 of 114 built	None of them live yet
Entryway deck	88 of 88 cards, fronts and backs, print and play PDF built	Complete, not yet live
Catalogue	155 priced items, all with active Stripe links in the repo	Ready, not reachable
Email list	0	The compounding asset, still at zero
Revenue, all time	\$19, one sale	Discovery is the constraint

Before any traffic: the gates

These are ordered. Each is cheap, and each one makes the next measurable.

#	Gate	Why it comes first	Who
1	Redeploy the site	Fixes the payment outage, and ships 102 zone photographs, seven articles that currently 404, the finished deck and the corrected legal pages	Phil
2	Buy one item from the live link yourself	Proves an order actually delivers end to end. The fulfilment job runs and reports delivering, but it has processed one order ever	Phil

3	Read Umami once	Nothing in this system has ever read the analytics. Without it, any money spent on traffic buys a number nobody can see	Phil
4	Get a phone number and publish the Google Business Profile	Free, drafted already, and required before local search ads are worth running	Phil
5	Stand up a free-tier email provider	The list is zero and every page's signup form is inert. This is the only asset that compounds	Phil decides, I build

On gate 5: the blocker recorded as issue #15 assumes the list must live on the Listmonk instance shared with another brand, which cannot send under two identities. It does not have to. A free tier under the 6S Success name removes the shared-identity problem entirely and the form-placement script already exists. That is a decision, not a build.

Where the \$250 goes

The digital catalogue is the wrong target for paid traffic and the arithmetic says so plainly: a \$19 pack nets about \$17.91, which no realistic cost per click survives. The two consulting offers are different. One In-Home Reset Day is \$1,200, which is nearly five times this entire budget, and it is bought by people typing a local search. So the money goes local, or it does not go.

#	Line	\$	What it buys, and how you know it worked
1	Local search ads, exact match only	112	About two weeks at \$8 a day on terms like 'professional organizer boise', 15 mile radius, no display network, no broad match. Measured on enquiries and cost per click, not on a conversion rate
2	Ad reserve, released once	48	Held back deliberately. Released only if line 1 produces clicks but no enquiry, to retest one changed variable. If line 1 produces no clicks at all, this moves to line 3
3	One pilot reset day: supplies and printing	60	A free or at-cost reset of one real household in exchange for written permission to photograph. Six matched before and after pairs of a real home are the strongest proof this site could carry, and it currently has none
4	Cards and printed decks for partner outreach	30	About 250 business cards and a few properly printed decks as a leave-behind for senior move managers, agents and organizers. The outreach templates are already written
Total		250	

What \$112 can and cannot measure

At a plausible cost per click for local organizer terms, \$112 buys somewhere in the region of fifteen to thirty clicks. That sample cannot measure a conversion rate, and I will not pretend otherwise: zero enquiries from twenty clicks is entirely consistent with a healthy business. What it can measure reliably, even at that size, is whether those searches happen here at all and what a click costs. Both are decision-grade and neither is obtainable any other way. The most likely single outcome is zero enquiries. Plan for it.

Check the keyword planner before committing. If exact-match clicks cost more than about ten dollars, \$112 buys single digits and the test cannot answer anything. In that case move lines 1 and 2 into two more pilot reset days instead. That is a real branch, not a formality.

What I would not spend a dollar on

Not this	Because
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Paid traffic to the digital catalogue	A \$19 product nets \$17.91. No realistic click price survives that
Meta or Pinterest ads	Home organisation is genuinely strong on Pinterest, which is the argument for posting there free first. Paying before one free post has been tested is buying an unknown
Amazon ads for the book	The book is ready but not published. A brand-new book with no reviews is the standard way to lose a budget on Amazon
Tools and subscriptions	Analytics, payments, search console and ads management are already free or self-hosted here. This is where small budgets quietly go
Backlink or directory packages	Already researched and declined. They skew toward link schemes

The organic plan, which is the real one

The site has 189 pages and, as far as can be measured, almost no external links. Content quality is not the bottleneck: a similarity test across all 6,441 pairs of zone pages found a median overlap of 0.10 after removing template words, which is strong evidence these are genuinely distinct pages rather than one page with the nouns swapped. Being found by other people is the bottleneck.

When	What to expect	What to do
Weeks 0 to 2	Indexing, not traffic	Submit the sitemap the day the deploy lands. Watch pages indexed, not clicks
Weeks 2 to 8	Impressions before clicks	This is the first real evidence of what people search for. Do not write new pages. Fix titles on pages already getting impressions
Months 2 to 6	The authority problem	Organic alone will not solve discovery in this window. The free standards sheets and the 114-zone index are the two assets most able to earn a link honestly

Fixes worth making first

Fix	Why
Room page title reads 'How to organize a entryway'	Three times on the room most likely to rank first
About 2,700 internal links point at the non-canonical URL form	The site declares one form canonical and links the other everywhere
www does not redirect to the apex	A complete duplicate of the site on a second hostname
Every zone page shares one social preview image	102 of them now have their own photograph and do not use it
The Quest's 684 cards exist only inside JavaScript	The most differentiated asset on the site is invisible to search engines and answer engines alike

Media capability, measured today

Capability	State	Evidence
Local image generation	Working	Stable Diffusion on the RTX 2070 SUPER, about 5 seconds an image. 202 images generated and reviewed this week

Hosted image APIs	One of seven authenticates	Gemini only. OpenAI, Cloudflare, Replicate, Stability, Hugging Face and Runway have no credential
Card and page rendering	Working	Headless Chromium renders card fronts and backs at print resolution
Video, photo led	Working, new today	Vertical 1080x1920, slow push, karaoke captions burned in with ffmpeg. Two built and checked
Video, typographic	Working, now superseded	Was chosen only because zones had no photographs. 102 now do
Voice over	Not usable	Only robotic system voices. Short form is watched muted, so captions carry the content
Stock footage and music	None	No library on this machine

Video roadmap

The unlock is that 102 micro zones now have a reviewed photograph. The old zone video format was a text slide, chosen because there were no pictures, and a text slide does not hold attention on a feed. Every word still comes from that zone's own entry, so nothing is written to fill a beat.

Stage	Output	Cost	Gate
1. Zone videos	102 vertical clips, 15 to 30 seconds, one per reviewed zone	About 90 minutes of machine time	Only zones whose photograph passed review
2. Card videos	88 Entryway card clips from the rendered fronts	Similar	Only cards whose art passed review
3. Before and after	The strongest asset the site could carry, and the one thing generation cannot fake	Needs a real household and written permission	Never publish a private home without a signed release
4. Room tours	20 room level clips assembled from zone stills	Low	After stage 1

Sequencing note: stages 1 and 2 are cheap and produce a lot of material, which is exactly why they should not run before the deploy. Publishing a hundred videos that point at a site which cannot take money spends the material once and teaches nothing.

What only you can do

#	Action	Where
1	Redeploy the site. This fixes the payment outage	Hostinger Docker Manager
2	Confirm Umami and Listmonk are not on default passwords, and close their public ports. Both admin apps are reachable from the open internet over plain HTTP	Hostinger, host firewall
3	Turn on HTTP/2 and HSTS, and redirect www to the apex	Nginx Proxy Manager
4	Decide the email provider so the list can start	Issue #15
5	Decide how the card decks are sold	Issue #20

Item 2 is the one genuine security finding. Neither app is behind the domain's TLS, so their logins cross the internet in clear text. I did not test their passwords, deliberately.